

05 FOOD IS FUEL

Your body can't run without the right food.

SEASON
1

WEEK
5

FOCUS
HEALTHY HABITS

KEY PHRASE
“Be unrealistic.”

SUMMARY

This practice focuses on eating as preparation for training. The coach leads a This or That activity where fighters choose between food options, then explains that whole foods give steady energy while sugary snacks cause a burst and a crash. Training introduces the uppercuts (5 and 6), adds 20-second speed bursts, works 5 • 6 to the body on the mitts, and builds a combination pyramid.

MATERIALS

- Mitts & gloves
- Cones or tape to mark the two sides

No journal this week, the activity is spoken, not written.

OBJECTIVES

By the end of this practice, fighters will:

1. Discuss the importance of eating as a way to prepare for training
2. Determine whether an available food option is fuel or not

COACH MESSAGE

15 MIN

SAY

Today we're going to continue our conversation about being prepared, and we'll start with a This or That activity.

ACTIVITY • THIS OR THAT

Directions

1. Designate one side of the room **this** and the other **that**.
2. Read the statement.
3. Fighters move to the side they agree with.
4. Ask fighters to share why they chose that side.
5. Fighters return to the middle before the next statement.

STATEMENTS

BREAKFAST

1. I'm not hungry so I shouldn't eat **or** I should eat something small even if I'm not hungry
2. Fruit Loops **or** tamale

LUNCH

1. Skip lunch **or** don't skip lunch
2. School pizza **or** cup of noodles

SNACK

1. Eat the school snack **or** eat the hot chips I saved from home
2. Rely on a friend to bring me chips **or** pack my own snack the night before
3. Hot chips **or** apple slices

SAY

Just like a car can't run without gas, your body can't run without the right food. When we fuel our bodies with good food, fruits, vegetables, protein, water, we feel stronger, sharper, and more confident. Choose foods that are fresh and close to their natural form, not boxed or full of things you can't pronounce.

The better options in this activity have characteristics that fuel your body. A tamale is filling and includes carbs and protein. Fruit Loops have a lot of sugar, you can taste it. Sugar gives a quick burst, then makes you crash. You need steady energy to stay strong through practice.

Good fuel for breakfast includes oatmeal with fruit or Greek yogurt. Low-fuel breakfasts include candy bars, sugary cereals, and energy drinks.

Protein makes your muscles stronger, it builds and repairs muscle after a workout, which matters for boxers. High-protein foods include eggs, peanut butter, turkey wraps, and beans. Low-protein foods are chips, pastries, and most fast food.

SAY

In general we want to avoid processed foods. Processed means the food has been changed from its original form before you eat it. An apple picked from a tree is not processed; mash it up, add sugar, and turn it into a fruit snack, and it is. A lot of packaged foods, chips, candy, cookies, soda, are processed. Factories add extra sugar, salt, or chemicals to make them taste good or last longer.

Not all processed food is bad, but it's usually better for your body to eat foods closer to how they are in nature, fruits, vegetables, nuts, whole grains.

Although school food may not be something we love, it is always better to eat than to skip a meal. If we don't eat for a long stretch at the beginning of the day, our body starts burning through muscle, and muscle matters for boxers. Don't be fooled into thinking skipping breakfast is healthier than a good breakfast.

Before we start training, think about how your body feels right now. Did you eat before you came? What did you have? Could your body use more energy or hydration?

During training, notice how your body responds. Are you tired? Focused? Alert? That's your body talking to you. Let's pay attention to it.

 INTENTIONS**5 MIN****SAY**

Today's guiding question: what do you intend to do after training to take care of your body?

*Every fighter shares out loud. There is no journal this week, end each intention with **snap clap**.*

TRAINING

30 MIN

UPPERCUT TECHNIQUE (5 AND 6) New skill

- Watch the uppercut video, or explain the uppercut yourself.
- Start with feet shoulder-width apart.
- Squat down and tap the ground next to the right foot, then swipe forward until the hand is in front of the face and the elbow bends. Repeat on the other side.
- Switch to boxing stance and continue the movement, hands by the face.
- Call **5**, then **6**; then call them predictably, then unpredictably.

WATCH OUT

- Fighters should not pull the arm back and wind up.
- The body twists with the arm.
- No leaning side to side, squat straight down and twist up.
- The uppercut hand stays connected to the face until the last second.

SPEED UPPERCUT SHADOW 20-second bursts

- Four 20-second bursts of shadow 5 · 6, 40 seconds rest between.
- Speed over power. Hands return to the face every time.
- Watch for winding up as fighters get tired, call it out immediately.

MITT WORK · 5 · 6 TO THE BODY 3 rounds

- Explain the mitt adjustment for the uppercut: mitt at chin level, mitts facing down, right to right and left to left.
- **Round 1:** 5 · 6, give individual feedback, watching for winding up.
- **Round 2:** 1 · 2 · 5
- **Round 3:** 1 · 2 · slip · 6
- Switch roles.

COMBO PYRAMID Shadow boxing · add one punch each round

- Every round is shadow boxed, no mitts and no partner. Fighters work in their own space.
- **Round 1:** 1
- **Round 2:** 1 · 2
- **Round 3:** 1 · 2 · 3
- **Round 4:** add one more punch, and keep adding a punch every round after.
- Build to a five- or six-punch combination, then work back down.
- If form breaks, drop back a round before adding again.

 BURNOUT · AMRAP**7 MIN**

- As many rounds as possible in three minutes: 10 squats, 10 shadow 1 · 2 · 3 combos, 10 skaters, 20 fast feet.
- Fighters count their rounds and remember the number.
- Fighters who finish a round cheer the others through theirs.

 SHOUT-OUTS**3 MIN**

- Ask the group: what did you see our team do that helped us get to our goal?
- Fighters share shout-outs, each ending with **snap clap**.